

The antivirus module is licensed from Computer Associates. Just like any decent antivirus, this one too is capable of scanning files in real-time as well as on demand and on schedule. With a smart heuristics system in place, the antivirus is effective against all kinds of malicious code, including viruses and trojans, even before there's a signature available for them. It works out to be extremely effective in conjunction with the firewall.

The firewall module was already perfected by Zone Labs, so it's pretty obvious that it's the firewall that's the biggest selling point of this package. The firewall features intrusion blocking technology that systematically identifies hackers and blocks access attempts, along with a stealth mode that automatically makes your computer invisible to anyone on the Internet. The firewall is pretty easy to set up and configure, which makes it convenient even for novice users.

The antispam module is licensed from MailFrontier. It integrates well with e-mail clients such as Outlook Express and filters out all the incoming spam quite effectively. It even monitors the outgoing mail for any suspicious activities, such as too many receivers for a single mail or too many mails being sent in too short a time interval. The IMSecure module protects your Internet messengers from spim and any other suspicious activity.

Other features include modules for privacy protection, which includes cookie control, ad blocking and protection from malicious scripts. There's also a parental lock for preventing access to sites unsuitable for children.

Pros: Excellent firewall; antivirus and antispam.

Cons: antispam doesn't filter your existing inbox.

Panda Platinum Internet Security 2005

Panda Platinum Internet Security 2005 is designed to be the only package you will need to protect yourself from all kinds of problems that you can get into while online. The package integrates an antivirus application, a spam filter, a firewall, and even parental control technology that can block objectionable content such as pornographic sites.